Noel and one of the trusts' nominee directors on the board had voted against it. Tata Trusts maintained that Chandrasekaran's decision not to offer himself for reappointment had already been accepted and had "attained finality". In a separate statement, Noel pointed to the possibility of a "serious legal challenge by any shareholder" to Chandrasekaran's reappointment, hinting at a potential legal battle ahead.

During the meeting, Noel was also reportedly outvoted in his attempt to block the Tata Sons listing. In another statement, he said the board should consider options such as restructuring to avoid a public listing, seek legal opinion and ask to be heard by the RBI. Besides Noel and Chandrasekaran, the board comprises industrialist Venu Srinivasan, former Hindustan Unilever chairman Harish Manwani, investment professional Anita M. George and Tata Group chief financial officer Saurabh Agrawal.

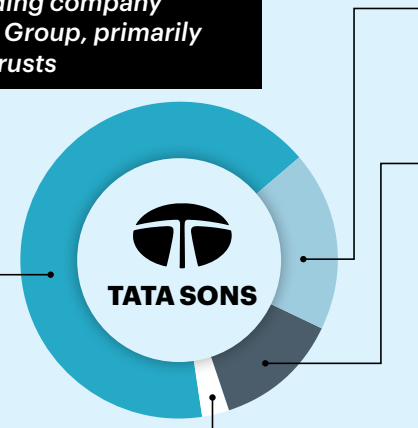
THE PUSH FOR LISTING

Tata Sons falls under the RBI's NBFC framework as a Core Investment Company (CIC), reflecting its role as the principal holding and investment company for the group, allocating capital and holding shares in various Tata companies. Specifically, it qualifies as an upper-layer NBFC, which requires it to get listed. Under the current norms, the upper layer comprises NBFCs with assets of Rs 1 lakh crore or more, based on the latest audited balance sheet. Tata Sons had a standalone asset size of Rs 1.75 lakh crore in FY26.

H.P. Ranina, a senior Supreme Court advocate, says Tata Sons fits the upper-layer NBFC classification both because of its asset size and because its holdings in listed companies give it indirect access to public funds. "RBI guidelines are mandatory and apply uniformly to all companies," he says. The RBI's current upper-layer list has 17 NBFCs. In an attempt to bolster its case for declassification, Tata Sons repaid over Rs 20,300 crore of debt and became debt-free. But the RBI rejected its plea to surrender its CIC registration.

WHO OWNS TATA SONS

Tata Sons is the principal investment holding company and promoter of the ₹16.2 lakh crore Tata Group, primarily controlled by a handful of philanthropic trusts



TATA TRUSTS — **65.9%**

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust	27.98%
Sir Ratan Tata Trust	23.56%
JRD Tata Trust	4.01%
Tata Education Trust	3.73%
Tata Social Welfare Trust	3.73%
R.D. Tata Trust	2.19%
MK Tata Trust	0.6%
Sarvajanik Seva Trust	0.1%

INDIVIDUALS — **2.7%**


Ratan Tata# **0.83%**


Noel Tata **1%**

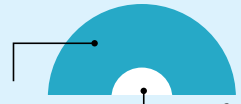

Jimmy Tata **0.81%**

Others **0.06%**

#Following his death in October 2024, Ratan Tata's shares are held in a trust

THE TATA EMPIRE

The numbers behind one of India's largest business groups



Revenues, FY26 **₹16.2 LAKH CR.**

Profits, FY26 **₹1.7 LAKH CR.**

Market cap of listed companies* **₹22.7 LAKH CR.**

Estimated market cap of Tata Sons **₹9-14 LAKH CR.**

**As on Sept. 15*

There are 17 unlisted companies in the Tata Group, prominent being Air India, Tata Industries, Tata AIA and Tata Projects besides Tata Sons. The 26 listed companies include Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Tata Steel, Tata Motors, Tata Chemicals and Tata Power. Under listing norms, Tata Sons will initially have to dilute 2.5 per cent of its stake to the public, rising to 15 per cent within five years and 25 per cent within 10 years. Tata Trusts, which currently hold 66 per cent of Tata Sons, other group companies and the Tata family would therefore retain a 75 per cent stake. But listing would bring Tata Sons under quarterly investor scrutiny and it would require shareholder approval for key decisions, including the appointment, reappointment or removal of board members and their remuneration, appointment of statutory auditors, preferential issues, and corporate restructuring such as mergers and demergers.

Chandrasekaran reportedly favours going public, while Noel prefers to keep the holding company unlisted to protect the Tata Group's century-old philanthropic legacy. Tata Sons is majority-owned by Tata Trusts, which have a controlling economic interest and veto rights over board appointments and certain strategic matters. The largest